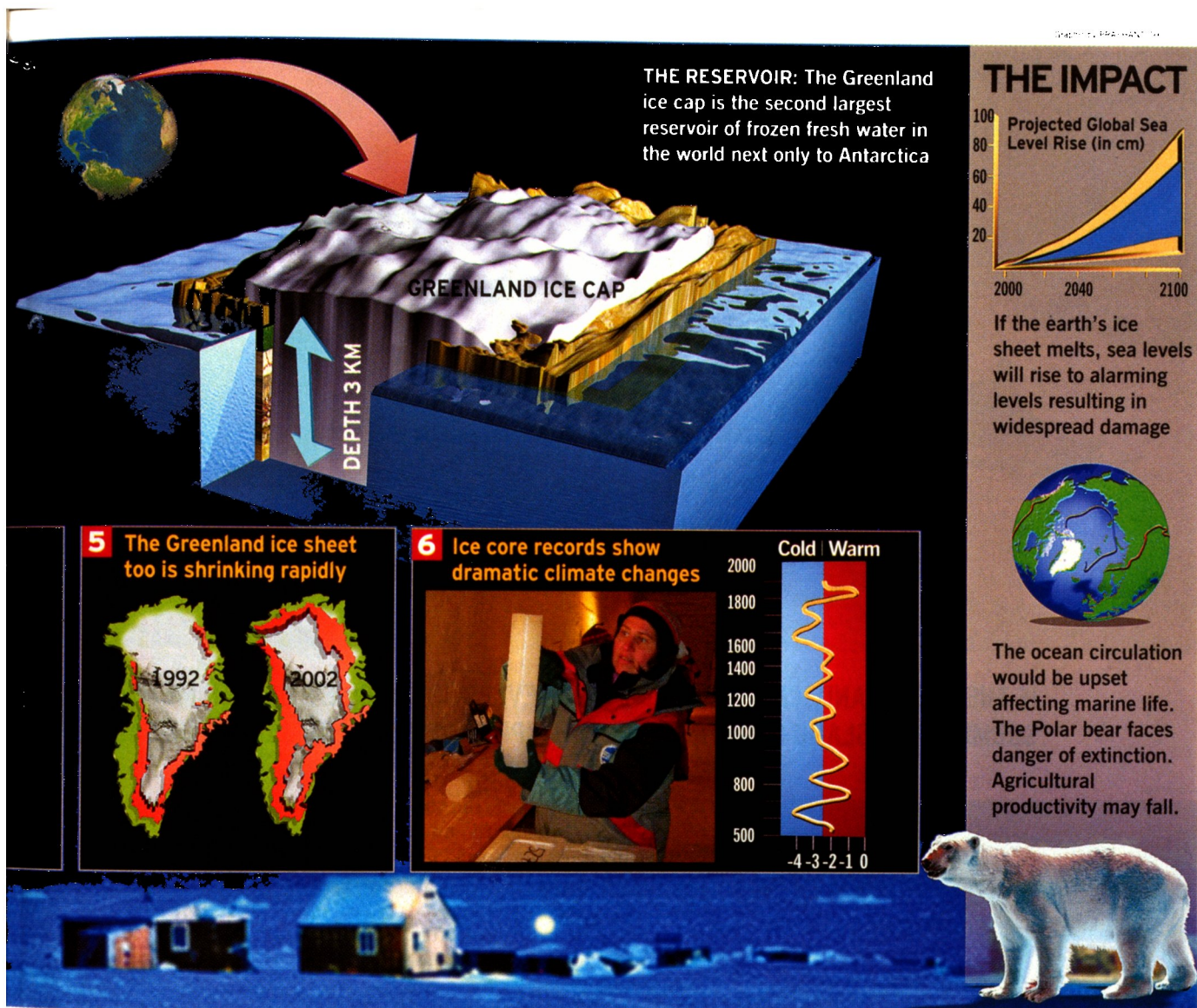




conditions prevailed on earth 1,20,000 years ago or in prehistoric times. What they are homing on is the Eemian era, a geological period that saw an interglacial age and had climatic conditions somewhat warmer to what we are experiencing now. Dorthe Dahl-Jensen, a leading Danish scientist and the head of the research team, says: "Where would you put your bet? Wait for global warming or get your record from here."

The world is now betting on the massive scientific effort to come up with answers to Greenland's fragile environment that today has become the ground zero of climate change.

The Greenland ice sheet, a relic of the Ice Age, is the second largest reservoir of frozen fresh water in the world next only to that of Antarctica. If all its ice melted, sea levels would rise over seven metre submerging many island countries like the Maldives and swamping coastal cities like Mumbai.

The news is already bad and getting worse: Average temperatures over Greenland are around five degrees warmer in recent times. In 2007, the ice melt was 30 per cent more than the previous year—a new record. The ice is now melting at a rate much faster than the amount Greenland puts back every winter resulting in a wor-



“I hope we can arrest global warming or else my children will not see the Polar Bear the way my generation saw them.”

KIM KIELSEN *Greenland's Minister for Infrastructure, Housing, Minerals and Petroleum*